

Congregation Bible Study Conductor Notes - August 10-16, 2026

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Walk Courageously With God ([wcg](#)) | Chapter 3: Sarah - She Refused to Look Back

Theme to keep returning to: Sarah's courage was steady and practical. She left comfort, accepted change, stayed loyal under pressure, and kept looking ahead to Jehovah's promises.

Opening Comments (~1 min)

Brothers and sisters, tonight we will consider Sarah. Her courage was not shown on a battlefield, but it was still very real. She left a secure city, lived in tents, endured uncertainty, protected her marriage, and kept trusting Jehovah's promise even when fulfillment seemed impossible from a human viewpoint.

As we conduct the study, let us watch for this point: courage is often shown by refusing to look back. Sarah did not keep longing for the life she had left behind. She looked ahead to Jehovah's promise. That same kind of courage can help us when Jehovah's direction asks us to accept change, simplify, or wait patiently.

Chapter Overview

Adlib Before the Opening Question

Sarah's story helps us broaden our view of courage. Sometimes courage means speaking, fighting, or taking a public stand. But for Sarah, courage often meant supporting Jehovah's direction quietly and consistently. She left Ur, accepted tent life, endured famine, faced danger in Egypt, and waited many years for Jehovah to fulfill his promise.

Question 1

Question from the book: In what ways did Sarah show courage?

Listen for: She left Ur and relatives; accepted a nomadic life in tents; supported Abraham instead of pressuring him to return; remained loyal to Abraham and Jehovah when Pharaoh took her; waited for Jehovah's promise; protected Isaac and kept looking ahead.

Commendation hint: “That is a balanced answer. You showed that Sarah’s courage was not one big moment only; it was a pattern over many years.”

Possible Follow-Up

Follow-up: Why can quiet endurance require real courage?

Direction: It may not be noticed by many people, but it takes faith to keep accepting inconvenience, uncertainty, or waiting without turning back.

Interesting thought: “That makes Sarah’s example very practical. Some of the strongest courage is shown quietly and consistently.”

Dig Deeper

Question 2

Question from the book: 1. Was it wrong for Sarah to marry Abraham even though he was her half brother? (wp17.3 12 ¶5, ftn.)

Listen for: No. At that early time in human history, circumstances were different, and close-relative marriage was not yet prohibited as it later was under the Mosaic Law. Sarah and Abraham’s marriage was accepted by Jehovah.

Commendation hint: “That was clear and careful. You explained the point in its historical setting instead of judging it by later standards.”

Possible Follow-Up

Follow-up: What does this teach us about reading Bible accounts from very early human history?

Direction: We should consider the time period, Jehovah’s progressive direction, and what the account is meant to teach.

Possible response: “Good context. That helps us read the account with respect for Jehovah’s timing and standards.”

Question 3

Question from the book: 2. Describe what Sarah may have left behind in Ur. (wp17.3 13 ¶3-14 ¶2) A

Listen for: A settled home in a prosperous city, protection from city walls, family and friends, a marketplace, conveniences, possibly comfort, beauty, and cultural advantages.

Commendation hint: “That helps us feel the cost of her decision. Sarah was not leaving an empty life; she was leaving real comfort.”

Picture A Prompt

Question: Looking at Picture A, what does the jewelry from Ur help us imagine about Sarah’s world?

Direction: Ur was not primitive or empty. It had wealth, skill, beauty, and culture. Sarah’s sacrifice was meaningful.

Interesting thought: “That is useful. It reminds us that Sarah’s courage included giving up things that may have been attractive and familiar.”

Question 4

Question from the book: 3. What evidence shows that Abraham acted wisely when he concealed Sarah’s identity as his wife? (wp17.3 14 ¶6-15 ¶2)

Listen for: Sarah was exceptionally beautiful, and Abraham feared being killed so someone could take her. The danger was real because Pharaoh did take Sarah into his house. Abraham’s concern was not imaginary, and Jehovah rescued Sarah.

Commendation hint: “That answer uses the account well. You showed that Abraham’s concern was based on a real danger, not a lack of love for Sarah.”

Possible Follow-Up

Follow-up: What does Sarah’s loyalty during that frightening situation teach us?

Direction: She stayed loyal to Abraham and Jehovah under pressure. She did not use the situation to seek a more comfortable life away from Jehovah’s arrangement.

Possible response: “That brings out her heart. Even when a palace looked safer than tent life, Sarah stayed loyal to Jehovah’s promise.”

Question 5

Question from the book: 4. Although Sarah was submissive to Abraham, does that mean that she never spoke up? Explain. (g 1/08 29 ¶4-5) B

Listen for: No. Sarah respected Abraham's headship, but she was not passive. In a serious family matter, she expressed her view, and Jehovah told Abraham to listen to her. Submission did not remove her dignity, judgment, or voice.

Commendation hint: "That is well put. You showed that Bible submission is respectful, but it is not silence or weakness."

Picture B Prompt

Question: Looking at Picture B, what balance can Christian wives and husbands learn from Sarah and Abraham?

Direction: Wives can speak respectfully and courageously; husbands should listen humbly; both should value Jehovah's direction above personal preference.

Interesting thought: "That is practical for families. Courage and respect can work together in a spiritual marriage."

Reflect on the Lessons

Question 6

Question from the book: Compare Sarah and Lot's wife. In what ways were they similar? (Gen. 12:1; 13:5-7; 19:12, 15)

Listen for: Both had to leave familiar surroundings; both were connected to households affected by Abraham's choices; both faced a moment when Jehovah's direction required movement; both had to leave things behind.

Commendation hint: "That is a good comparison. You showed that both women faced a real test involving what they would leave behind."

Possible Follow-Up

Follow-up: Why is it helpful to compare people who faced similar circumstances?

Direction: It helps us see that the issue is not only the situation but the heart response to Jehovah's direction.

Possible response: "Exactly. The same type of test can reveal very different hearts."

Question 7

Question from the book: In what ways were they different? (Gen. 19:17, 26; Luke 17:28-32)

Listen for: Sarah kept looking ahead and supported Jehovah's direction; Lot's wife looked back longingly and disobeyed. Sarah refused to return to her old life, but Lot's wife showed attachment to what she was leaving.

Commendation hint: "That contrast is sharp and helpful. You showed that the heart can either look ahead in faith or look back with longing."

Possible Follow-Up

Follow-up: What might "looking back" look like today?

Direction: Romanticizing a former lifestyle, missing old associations, envying material comfort, or wishing we could lower Jehovah's standards.

Interesting thought: "That is practical. Looking back is often a heart direction before it becomes an action."

Question 8

Question from the book: What can we learn from the decisions they made and how things turned out for them?

Listen for: Jehovah blesses those who trust his direction and keep looking ahead. Attachment to what Jehovah tells us to leave can be dangerous. Our decisions reveal what we truly value.

Commendation hint: "That answer draws the lesson out clearly. The outcome of both women teaches us to keep our eyes on Jehovah's promise."

Question 9

Question from the book: Sarah was very beautiful, and her husband was wealthy. What example does she set for us regarding our view of any physical or material advantages we may have? (Prov. 31:30; 1 Tim. 6:17-19)

Listen for: Sarah did not build her security on beauty, comfort, or wealth. She used her life in support of Jehovah's purpose. We should not trust in appearance or riches but use any advantages to serve Jehovah and do good.

Commendation hint: "That keeps the point balanced. Advantages are not wrong, but Sarah teaches us not to make them our security."

Possible Follow-Up

Follow-up: How can a person use material advantages without trusting in them?

Direction: Keep life simple, be generous, support spiritual goals, avoid status thinking, and let Jehovah's promise shape decisions.

Possible response: "Good practical application. It is not what we have, but what our heart relies on."

Question 10

Question from the book: How might you imitate Sarah's courage in your life? C

Listen for: accept changes in assignment or circumstances, support family worship, avoid longing for an old life, choose spiritual goals over comfort, speak respectfully when needed, keep waiting on Jehovah.

Commendation hint: "That is a useful personal application. You made Sarah's courage something we can imitate in ordinary decisions."

Picture C Prompt

Question: Looking at Picture C, what kind of courage may be needed when a couple simplifies or moves to serve where there is a need?

Direction: Leaving comfort, adjusting to a new place, trusting Jehovah's support, and focusing on people rather than conveniences.

Interesting thought: “That connects well with Sarah. Simplifying may look exciting from the outside, but it takes faith day after day.”

Meditate on the Bigger Picture

Question 11

Question from the book: What does this account teach me about Jehovah?

Listen for: Jehovah notices faithful women; he values courage shown in family life; he protects loyal servants; he fulfills promises even when fulfillment seems impossible; he is patient with imperfect humans.

Commendation hint: “That is a warm answer. You helped us see Jehovah as attentive to Sarah’s faith, not just Abraham’s.”

Question 12

Question from the book: How does this account tie in with Jehovah’s purposes?

Listen for: Sarah became part of the family line leading to the promised offspring; Jehovah’s covenant with Abraham moved forward through Isaac; her courage supported the outworking of Jehovah’s purpose.

Commendation hint: “That connects the family account to Jehovah’s larger purpose. Sarah’s personal courage mattered in the outworking of the promise.”

Question 13

Question from the book: What would I like to ask Sarah in the resurrection?

Listen for: how she felt leaving Ur, what helped her not look back, how Jehovah comforted her, what it was like to have Isaac, how she supported Abraham through uncertainty.

Commendation hint: “That is a thoughtful question. It makes Sarah feel like a real person we will be able to meet and learn from.”

Optional Closing Follow-Up

Follow-up: What is one phrase from tonight's study that you want to remember?

Direction: "She refused to look back," "look ahead," "Jehovah fulfilled his promise," "quiet courage," or "support Jehovah's direction."

Possible response: "That is a fitting takeaway. A short phrase can stay with us when we face a choice this week."

Closing Thought (~30 sec)

Sarah's courage was steady. She left behind comfort, accepted uncertainty, stayed loyal under pressure, and kept looking ahead to Jehovah's promise. Her example helps us ask: Am I looking back at what Jehovah has helped me leave, or am I looking ahead to what he has promised? This week, let us imitate Sarah by trusting Jehovah's direction and refusing to look back.

Verified source pages

- English meeting schedule: <https://www.jw.org/en/library/jw-meeting-workbook/july-august-2026-mwb/Life-and-Ministry-Meeting-Schedule-for-August-10-16-2026/>
- Tagalog meeting schedule: <https://www.jw.org/tl/library/jw-workbook-para-sa-pulong/hulyo-agosto-2026-mwb/Iskedyul-ng-Pulong-Para-sa-Buhay-at-Ministryo-Para-sa-Agosto-10-16-2026/>
- English book study: <https://www.jw.org/en/library/books/walk-courageously-with-god/patriarchs-to-time-of-judges/sarah-refused-to-look-back/>